PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY MARK SCHEME

2020 Exam-Style Practice Paper

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75 (1HI0/33)

Question 1: Inference from Source A (4 Marks)

Target: AO3 (4 marks). Award 1 mark for each valid inference, up to 2. Award 1 mark for each corresponding quote/detail, up to 2.

Sample Acceptable Inferences (the March on Washington (1963)):

• **Inference 1:** The march was a massive, disciplined demonstration that brought together a diverse coalition of Americans.

- *Detail from source:* "More than 200,000 Americans, black and white, gathered peacefully... uniting religious leaders, labor unionists, students, and citizens from every corner of the country..."

• **Inference 2:** The march was aimed directly at demanding immediate political action on civil rights and economic opportunities.

- *Detail from source:* "carrying banners demanding equal rights, integrated schools, and decent jobs... in a single unified appeal to Congress and the nation."

Question 2: Causal Explanation (12 Marks)

Target: AO1/AO2 (12 marks). Level 4 (10–12 marks): An analytical explanation showing a line of reasoning with clear links to the outcome, supported by accurate, detailed knowledge.

“One reason why the civil rights movement grew in the years 1954–60 was the legal breakthrough of the Brown v. Topeka decision, which gave activists constitutional backing.” In 1954, the Supreme Court ruled that school segregation was unconstitutional. This historic victory proved that the legal foundation of Jim Crow could be dismantled, giving Black Americans the confidence to launch active campaigns. *Therefore, the Brown ruling was a primary cause of the movement's growth because it provided the legal precedent and hope needed to inspire local communities to organize protests.*

“A second reason why the civil rights movement grew in the years 1954–60 was the success and organization of the Montgomery Bus Boycott.” Triggered by **Rosa Parks**' arrest, the Montgomery Improvement Association (MIA), led by Martin Luther King Jr., organized a **381-day** boycott of the city's segregated buses. By setting up a highly coordinated **carpool system** and sustained economic pressure, they forced the bus company into financial crisis until the Supreme Court ruled bus segregation unconstitutional. *Therefore, the Montgomery Bus Boycott was a crucial cause of the movement's growth because it demonstrated that unified grassroots non-violent direct action could achieve concrete victories, providing a template for future protests.*

“A third reason why the civil rights movement grew in the years 1954–60 was the passage of the first federal civil rights laws in decades.” The **Civil Rights Act of 1957**, pushed by Senator Lyndon B. Johnson, established a Civil Rights Commission and a new division in the Department of Justice to protect voting rights. While the bill was watered down and only increased Southern Black registration by **3%**, it was the first civil rights legislation passed since Reconstruction. *Therefore, this legislation was a key cause of the movement's growth because it signaled that the federal government was beginning to accept its responsibility to protect Black citizens, encouraging activists to keep campaigning.*

Question 3(a): Source Utility (8 Marks)

Target: AO3 (8 marks). Assess content utility, verify with contextual knowledge, and evaluate provenance reliability and limitations for BOTH sources.

Source B is highly useful for showing the strategic failure of the US bombing campaign to disrupt communist logistics. The declassified report states that despite intensive air operations (Operation Rolling Thunder), Hanoi successfully increased the flow of troops and supplies, and that strikes failed to impede their supply lines or resolve. This content's utility is supported by my knowledge that the Vietcong and NVA adapted to the bombing by using underground tunnels, operating at night, and quickly repairing the Ho Chi Minh Trail using thousands of volunteers, which allowed them to keep fighting. The provenance of a secret military intelligence document from 1966 increases its usefulness because it represents the candid, private assessments of US command. Free from the need to present a positive view to the public, it reveals the early recognition of military failure, making it a highly reliable record of tactical deadlock.

Source C is highly useful for demonstrating the severe decline in US troop morale and combat discipline by the late stages of the war. The veteran describes rampant substance abuse, insubordination, and the assassination of an incompetent officer (fragging) using a grenade, indicating that the army was fighting itself. This content is verified by my knowledge that the US military faced a crisis of discipline after 1969, with hundreds of reported cases of fragging, widespread heroin use (affecting up to 15% of soldiers), and general refusal to engage in combat, which undermined operational effectiveness. The provenance of a retrospective television interview in 1981 by a combat veteran gives it high utility by providing an authentic, personal account of the internal collapse of the US army. However, it is limited because it represents a single soldier's experience in a specific unit and might be influenced by the post-war media narrative of the traumatized veteran.

Question 3(b): Difference Between Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Identify the main difference of view, supported by details from both interpretations.

The main difference is that Interpretation 1 argues that the US failed because the **"air campaign failed to halt the flow"** of enemy supplies. In contrast, Interpretation 2 argues that the failure was due to the internal collapse of the US army, citing how conscription led to a **"decline in discipline"**, drug abuse, and insubordination.

Question 3(c): Reason for Difference in Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Explain how the historians may have relied on different sources to reach their views.

The interpretations differ because the historians have focused on different aspects of the war. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which reports that air strikes failed to "significantly impede their supply lines", leading to the view that the **"air campaign failed to halt the flow"** of logistics. Conversely, Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which details how "morale in our unit decayed steadily" and describes the fragging of an officer, leading to the view that the US military suffered from a **"decline in discipline"**.

Question 3(d): Evaluation of Interpretation (16 Marks + 4 SPaG)

Target: AO4 (16 marks) + SPaG (4 marks). Level 4 (13–16 marks): Balanced discussion analyzing both interpretations with sustained contextual knowledge, leading to a justified judgment.

I agree to a moderate extent with Interpretation 2 that internal military collapse was a major cause of the US failure. My own knowledge confirms that the **draft system** conscripted young, unwilling men, and the **one-year tour** of duty meant units lacked cohesion and experience. By 1971, drug use was a major problem, and there were over **500** cases of **fragging** (soldiers murdering officers), showing a complete breakdown of command. As Source C notes, **morale in our unit decayed steadily** until it felt like they were **fighting ourselves**. This supports Interpretation 2's view that the **"decline in discipline"** and loss of belief in the mission made defeat inevitable.

However, Interpretation 1 is also valid in showing that the military strategy itself was flawed from the start. The US relied heavily on bombing campaigns like Operation **Rolling Thunder**, dropping more bombs on Vietnam than in all of World War II. Yet, as Source B shows, this air war failed to disrupt the **Ho Chi Minh Trail** because the North Vietnamese used primitive, labor-intensive repair methods. This confirms Interpretation 1's claim that the **"reliance on air power was insufficient"** because it was a conventional strategy used against a decentralized guerrilla force.

Overall, while the air war's strategic failure (Interpretation 1) created a prolonged stalemate, it was the resulting collapse of troop morale and discipline (Interpretation 2) that made it impossible for the US to continue. The draft and the high casualties of search-and-destroy missions destroyed the army's combat capability, forcing Nixon to withdraw troops. Therefore, the internal collapse was the decisive factor that ended US involvement.